Q+A

MUSICALLY YOURS

Sharman Joshi stars in *Music School*, which brings the spotlight back on an education system that snuffs the creativity out of kids

Q. What is your character in *Music School* about?
Manoj is a guy who, like Mary, the character Shriya [Saran] plays, is a music teacher grappling with the fact that parents don't allow their kids enough time for extracurricular activities. The two try to bring about a change by opening a little music school.... I think kids have been put under too much pressure by the education system. But there are positive changes in the works that will hopefully be implemented soon.

Q. There are 11 songs in *Music School*. How important are music and songs in contemporary filmmaking?
Music and songs have been a very integral part of our filmmaking. However, with changing times and the difference in the way we now approach our cinema–which needs to be tighter and match with international standards in terms of storytelling and the time frames–some films may have songs and some may not.

Q. How was the experience of working with your co-star Shriya Saran and director Paparao Biyyala?
Shriya brings a lot of laughter and fun to the set, but she is also a thorough professional and I loved working with her.... Mr Biyyala was new to the industry and comes from an administrative background. Often, he tended to equate running a film set with running an administrative office–but the former requires tenderness and love. However, he caught on quickly and it was a pleasure working with him.

Q. What other projects are you working on currently?
I've done six projects just before the lockdown and post that. I had a Gujarati release a few months back and *Music School* is my second film that is now making it to theatres. I have a web show called *Kafas* coming up soon. Apart from that, I have an Abbas-Mustan film, a film with Umesh Shukla and another that is being presented by Anurag Kashyap and is directed by Abhinav Pareek. So some interesting stuff lined up.

with Amit Dixit

